

FREE CHECKLIST

HR Compliance Checklist for Government Contractors

The compliance requirements every government contractor needs in place — especially before a contract award.

Government contractors face HR compliance requirements that go beyond standard employment law. This checklist covers the most critical areas. The time to build your HR infrastructure is before the contract award surge — not during it.

I-9 AND EMPLOYMENT ELIGIBILITY

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| 1 | ☐ I-9 forms completed for all employees
Section 1 by employee on or before day one. Section 2 by employer within 3 business days. | High |
| 2 | ☐ I-9 forms stored separately from personnel files
Required by federal regulation. Commingling I-9s with personnel files is a common violation. | High |
| 3 | ☐ Annual I-9 audit completed to identify errors and expired documents
Proactive audits prevent violations and demonstrate good faith compliance efforts. | High |
| 4 | ☐ E-Verify enrollment completed if required by contract
FAR clause 52.222-54 requires E-Verify for most federal contracts over \$150,000. | High |

EEO AND AFFIRMATIVE ACTION

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| 5 | ☐ EEO-1 report filed annually if required
Required for federal contractors with 50+ employees and contracts of \$50,000 or more. | High |
| 6 | ☐ Written Affirmative Action Plan (AAP) in place if required
Required for contractors with 50+ employees and contracts of \$50,000 or more. | High |
| 7 | ☐ AAP updated annually and available for OFCCP audit
OFCCP can audit at any time. AAP must be current, documented, and accessible. | High |
| 8 | ☐ Job postings include required EEO tagline
All job postings must include the required equal opportunity employer statement. | Medium |

VEVRAA AND SECTION 503 — VETERANS AND DISABILITY

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| 9 | ☐ Veteran status tracked and reported in VETS-4212 report
Required annually for contractors with federal contracts of \$150,000 or more. | High |
| 10 | ☐ Job postings include required veteran and disability language
Specific language required for protected veterans and individuals with disabilities. | High |
| 11 | ☐ Self-identification forms provided to applicants and employees
Voluntary self-ID for disability (Section 503) and veteran status (VEVRAA) required. | High |
| 12 | ☐ Reasonable accommodation process documented and communicated
Process for requesting and responding to accommodation requests must be in place. | Medium |

COMPENSATION AND PAY EQUITY

13	☐	Service Contract Act or Davis-Bacon wage rates applied if required Many service and construction contracts require specific wage determinations by role.	High
14	☐	Pay equity analysis completed across protected classes OFCCP focuses heavily on compensation equity during compliance evaluations.	High
15	☐	Compensation recordkeeping meets federal retention requirements Payroll and compensation records must be retained for at least 3 years.	Medium

GENERAL HR COMPLIANCE

16	☐	Employee handbook current and includes required federal contractor policies Must include EEO, anti-harassment, pay transparency, and accommodation policies.	High
17	☐	Required federal and state labor law posters displayed Federal contractor posters include additional requirements beyond standard employers.	High
18	☐	Background check process compliant with FCRA Federal contractors must follow strict rules on timing and adverse action procedures.	High
19	☐	Manager training on EEO, harassment, and accommodation completed Documented training is critical evidence of good faith compliance efforts during OFCCP audits.	High

Need help putting these in place?

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